Contemporary Philippine Arts from Regions

Quarter 1 – Module 4:

EXPRESSIONS OF PHILIPPINE CONTEMPORARY ARTS

OBJECTIVES:

- Identify the contemporary practice in the arts
- Describe traditional and non-traditional materials used by contemporary Filipino artist.
- Recognize some techniques used in the art forms
- Research on contemporary choreographic and acting techniques
- Critique available materials and appropriate techniques
- Justify the use of materials and the application of certain techniques

1. He was fond of using a leaf which his lips in humming musical tunes. During the Christmas season, children sing Christmas carols with the help of their tin cans and sticks or stones.

A. JOSE MARI CHAN C. LEA SALONGA
B. LEVI CELERIO D. RYAN CAYABYAB

2. A technique where a dancer is standing behind another while doing the same steps.

A. CANON C. RETROGRADE
B. MIRRORING D. SHADOWING

3. A. techniques where dancers face each other while doing the same steps.

A. CANON C. RETROGRADE
B. MIRRORING D. SHADOWING

4. A hollow wooden Igorot drum topped with pigskin.

A. OCTAVINA C. SOLIBAO

5. Dancers performing similar steps in a successive manner.

A. CANON C. RETROGRADE

B. MIRRORING D. SHADOWING

6. In Laog, Ilocos Norte, honors our Lady of Piat in a week-long festival during the last week of June. It also commemorates the Sambali tribe, who were converted to Christianity.

A. HERMOSA FESTIVAL C. PAMULINAWEN FESTIVAL

B. PAHIYAS FESTIVAL D. TABAKO FESTIVAL

7. A set of gongs placed on a narrow supporting table played in particular by the Maranao and Maguindanao people.

A. GANGSA C. KUTYAPI

B. KULINTANG D. SOLIBAO

8. It is held during the last week of March, as gratitude for a bountiful harvest.

A. BANGUS FESTIVAL
B. KADAYAWAN ANNUAL FESTIVAL
C. BUTANDING FESTIVAL
D. MASKARA FESTIVAL

9. A reverse performance of a sequence of dance steps

A. CANON
B. MIRRORING
C. RETROGRADE
D. SHADOWING

10. The way a writer arranges words and thoughts to create moods or atmospheres, or to evoke the feeling he or she wants to express.

A. ACTING TECHNIQUE
B. MUSICAL TECHNIQUE
C. STRATEGY TECHNIQUE
D. WRITING TCHNIQUE

11. An ensemble of stringed instruments played with a pick, is popular in the regions.

A. GANGSA C. RONDALLA

B. OCTAVINA D. TONGATONG

12. A two stringed lute played by the Maguindanao people.

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13. It is held every third of January to honor the image of the Sto. Nino de Cebu, which was brought by the Spaniards when they landed in Mactan in 1521.

A. ATI-ATIHAN C. PAHIYAS

B. DINAGYANG D. SINULOG

14. She is a national artist and choreographer of Bayanihan Dance Company.

A. AGNES C. LOCSIN
B. EDNA VIDA
C. LUCRECIA R. URTULA
D. SHIRLEY HALILI-CRUZ

15. A reverse performance of a sequence of dance steps

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Festivals and Rituals: Representation of Philippine Arts

Perhaps one collaborative art that is common to every region is the festival. The Philippines has festivals or every kind: festivals honoring patron saints (a carry-over from the Catholic Spanish-colonial tradition), thanksgiving for a bountiful harvest, commemoration of an event, and tribute to special occasion or a local specialty. The celebration for festivals has become a collaborative art that involves many art forms and styles. A festival may be composed of street-dancing, singing competitions, architectural decors like floats and a lot more.

Some of these festivals have become tourist attractions. The *Sinulog Festival* in Cebu is one of them. It is held every third Sunday of January to honor the image of the Sto. Niño de Cebu, which was brought by the Spaniards when they landed in Mactan in 1521. The *Dinagyang* festival of Iloilo, celebrated every fourth Sunday of January, is also honor of the Sto. Nino commemorating the arrival of Malay settlers in Panay and the selling of the island to them by the Atis. Another festival that honors the Sto. Nino is the *Ati-*

"SINULOG FESTIVAL" https://guidetothephilippines.ph/articles/history-culture/sinulog-festival-cebu-guide

Atihan in Kalibo, Aklan. Held on the third Sunday of January, it features a parade of drumbeating Ati-Atihans (make believe Atis) and the cry of "hala bira".

The *Pahiyas* of Lucban, Quezon, is held annually on May 15 in honor of San Isidro Labrador, the patron saint of farmers. Houses along the procession route are decorated with colorful *kiping* made of colored and cooked rice dough with a leaf-shape design.

"Pahiyas Festival" https://www.pinterest.ph/pin/216313588322559829/

In Marinduque, the most popular festival is the *Moriones Festival* that re-enacts the story of Longinus, the centurion who pierced the side of Jesus Christ on the cross. This festival is help during the Holy Week of Lent. The *Pamulinawen Festival* in Laog, Ilocos Norte, honors our Lady of Peace every tenth of February. In Piat, Cagayan, a week-long festival during the last week of June commemorates the Sambali tribe, who converted to Christianity.

A performer smiles at the camera during dance number of the Hermosa Festivals in Zamboanga del Sur. Photo Courtesy of FilAm MegaScene, Chicago

The *Hermosa Festival* in Zamboanga, also known as Fiesta Pilar, is month-long festival held in October, honoring the image of our Lady of the Pilar.

Thanksgiving festivals are held in different regions. Here are some of them: The *Tabako Festival* in Candon Ilocos Sur, is held during the last week of March as gratitude for a bountiful harvest. The *Butanding Festival* in Bicol from April 28 to 30, not only ushers in the Butanding (whale shark) season but also gives thanks for the blessings given to the people of Donsol, Sorsogon. In Davao City, the *Kadayawan Annual Festival* is a thanksgiving for the gifts of Nature and a celebration of life every third week of August.

Festivals commemorating events and honoring specialties of an area are also popular. An example of these is the Panagbenga in Baguio City, the festival of flowers; it was started to revive the city's industry after the devastation of the 1990 Luzon earthquake. The festival has been a Baguio trademark since then. The *Pattaraday Festival* in Santiago City, Cagayan, during the first week of May commemorates the founding anniversary of the city and the coming together of several ethnic groups. The Ybanag word pattaraday means "unity"

The *Maskara Festival* of Bacolod City pays tribute to the sugar industry that once flourished in the region. It is celebrated every third week of October. The performers wear smiling masks to give a brighter light to the fall of their industry which occurred in the 1970s.

The *F'lomlok Festival* in Polomolok, South Cotabato, showcases the local products of the region. F'lomlok is the B'laan term for "hunting grounds".

F'lomlok Festival in South Cotabato/Photo courtesy of Omar Gallinero

In the Ilocos region. Food specialties are honoured in festivals: *empanada* in Ilocos Norte in December; and *pinakbet*, *bagnet*, *tinadok* and exotic food in the *Gameng Festival* of Solsona, Ilocos Norte in January. There is also the *Bangus Festival* in Dagupan City, Pangasinan, held from April to the First Week of May.

Fluvial parades are also popular. Procession of decorated boats are held to honor patron saints. The most famous in the fluvial parade is *Our Lady of Peňafrancia* in Naga City every September, where millions of pilgrims, tourists, and devotees gather to join the festivities. Also, in Aparri, Cagayan, a procession of hundred decorated boats honor St. Peter Thelmo on May 10.

The festivals mentioned here are just some of the many festivals in the various regions. Some of them are sponsored by the Department of Tourism to attract tourists that add to the economic coffers. Some are politically motivated to push or campaign for a local interest. Whatever their purpose is, these festivals provide a temporary escape for the Filipinos by providing them with artistic wonders.

Rituals, or rites, are also examples of the Philippine folk tradition and art, practiced in almost every region. These are a part of the culture. They are a series of ceremonies or prescribed actions performed for a specific purpose. There are ceremonial rites, religious rites, betrothal and marriage rituals, the rite of passage and others. Rituals can be simple or complex, private, or public, and can last for a few minutes or stretch for days. The rituals are often accompanied by dancing.

Rituals exist in the regions because of a certain need, such as the need to obtain order and harmony in the individual, village, or community. There is a belief about the interrelationship of man, nature and the spirit world and that

balance must be maintained to achieve the state of order and harmony. The baylan (priest) or the babaylan (priestess) performs the rite. In other rituals, the shaman, a seer, or healer, acts as an intermediary between man and the spirit world, suing the art of magic.

Stretching further, rituals are found in ordinary, everyday life even the personal daily routines undergo a process of ritual, like the ritual of preparing for school, washing the hands, combing the hair, etc. the family has social rituals for greetings; the beso for friends and pagmamano, a respectful greeting of children to the elders.

Materials

Artists need physical materials to work on. They are how the artists make their feelings or thoughts visible. Through them, they transform their idea or experience into something tangible to be received by the audience, viewer, or listener.

In the past, materials for Filipino art forms have been clearly defined: paper and pen or a typewriter for the literary artist; paint, paper, or canvas for the visual artist; an instrument and/or a musical sheet for the musician. Some art forms call for Western- made materials and tools that are expensive like oil paints and brushes for the painter. Although some of them are still in use because they are part of classical art forms. Filipino artists have devised alternative materials from them.

Filipino artists have also rediscovered existing indigenous tools and instruments for their use.

Materials for visual design come in two forms: support and the medium. The support may refer to the primary material of which the work of art is made (e.g., paper, canvas, stone, textile) or the secondary material (e.g., paper glued or mounted on cardboard, textile over wood). For example, in music composition and the literary arts, the support is the paper and the tangible medium is ink.

When it comes to choosing their materials, Filipino contemporary artist does not conform to any fixed standard. They know that they have many choices. They can just look around their surroundings and find possibilities. For instance,

some have found objects that can be used as materials for assemblage and installation art and as musical instruments. The late Levi Celerio, National Artist for Music, was fond of using a leaf which his lips in humming musical tunes. During the Christmas season, children sing Christmas carols with the help of their tin cans and sticks or stones.

Various musicians and bands use alternative materials today. Several Filipino bands that play with unconventional musical instruments, like bamboo, have emerged. One of them is the *Banda Kawayan Pilipinas*, formerly known as the PUP Banda Kawayan. Because of the band's ingenuity, their music is recognized, not only in the country but in other countries as well.

Ten of the 50 active members of Banda Kawayan Pilipinas/Photo courtesy of Banda Kawayan Pilipinas

The *rondalla*, an ensemble of stringed instruments played with a pick, is popular in the regions. It is a carry-over from our Spanish heritage but has evolved with instruments made from indigenous Philippine wood. The picks are made from tortoise shell. Some of the instruments are the *banduria*, the *octavina* and the *laud*.

Traditional musical instruments in some regions are still used today. Some musical instruments from the Mt. Province are the *gangsa* played in the Cordillera region; *kalaleng* or *tangali* (nose flute) made of bamboo; the *tongatong*, a bamboo percussion instrument used by the Kalinga people; the *solibao*, a hollow wooden Igorot drum topped with pigskin; and the *ulibaw* or jew's harp.

In Mindanao, the *kulintang* is a set of gongs placed on a narrow supporting table played by the Maranao and Maguindanao people. The *Kutyapi* is a two stringed lute played by the Maguindanao people.

Solibao

Kulintang

Kutyapi

In a performance, artists need lights, unless it is daytime, and the performance is in outdoors. In the traditional theatre, stage lights are used but alternative lightings effects are also being utilized now. In traditional theatre, there are curtains that can be drawn between scenes.

In traditional choreography, dancers wear soft shoes. Today, they can wear any alternative footwear, and even design the footwear themselves. Anyhow, they can dance barefooted. There is no standard attire in contemporary choreography. In Quezon City, a youth group danced, using the *bakya* (wooden shoes) choreographed by the mentors Tony Fabella and Eddie Elejar. Dancers can improvise.

Today there is a crossover, or *hybridization* of materials. Local and traditional ones have committed with contemporary art forms. Before, materials were restricted to standard mediums and tools that were mostly borrowed from the West. Now whatever is available locally, suitable, and applicable to the art form is the norm. Local, traditional, and alternative materials have combined, creating a new unique Filipino style. Mixed media have become popular.

Filipinos are ingenious. They are adept at holding tools and using materials in different ways. They are also intuitive; they know that materials can be formed and fashioned in diverse ways and applied to their work with varying results. Experimentation and innovation are parts of the Filipino's daily life.

Techniques

Technique in the creation of arts can be defined in two ways: First, as the process or method that makes use of the materials on hand; and second, as the skill of the artist to execute his or her work and produce the effect he or she wants to achieve. It is a system in everything that artists do. There are diverse techniques for different art forms.

A *writing technique* is the way a writer arranges words and thoughts to create moods or atmospheres, or to evoke the feeling he or she wants to express. A *musical technique* is the way the musician handles his or her instrument to interpret a musical composition and to express the feeling he or she wants to evoke. In visual design, the visual *artist's technique* is his or her approach in using the medium to come out with the desired result.

In theatre, an *acting technique* is the manner of using facial expressions, gestures, and body movements to portray a character. A *dance technique* is the way of moving one's body to express an emotion or a desired state or condition.

Choreography Techniques

In choreography, the technique involves human movement and form within the elements of time, space, and shape. It also involves energy in a nonverbal and emotional context. There are two fundamental dance methods in choreography.

The first method is *planned*: the choreography prescribes the movements and forms in detail, giving little or no opportunity for the dancers to be creative. The other method is called *improvisation*: the choreographer allows the dancers freedom to interpret the general instructions. This is oftentimes referred to as “interpretative dancing”.

Traditional techniques are still being used. These are mirroring, retrograde, canon, level, shadowing

1. Mirroring – techniques where dancers face each other while doing the same steps.

2. Retrograde- reverse performance of a sequence of dance steps

3. Canon – dancers performing similar steps in a successive manner
4. Levels – varying positions of dancers
5. Shadowing – technique where a dancer is standing behind another while doing the same steps.
6. Unison – unanimous performance of steps.

Some noted Filipino choreographers are National Artist Lucrecia R. Urtula of the Bayanihan Dance Company, Leonor Orosa Goquingco of Filipinescas Dance Company, Ramon Obusan of the Ramon Obusan Folkloric Group, Alice Reyes of Ballet Philippines; Agnes C. Locsin; Shirley Halili-Cruz; Basilio Esteban Villaruz; the late Tony Fabella; and Edna Vida of Ballet Philippines. Try to watch the choreography directed by the mentioned artists to determine the most common techniques they use.

Acting Techniques

Acting techniques deal with the characterization of the human experience. It is used to create a mood to heighten tension. It involves the coordinators of facial expression, gesture, and speech to produce the emotion or feeling called for in the part.

Actors must learn basic acting techniques to be convincing in portraying the characters to the audience. Some acting techniques are the following: learning the rhythm of one's lines, employing word stress, and giving and receiving cues. Other techniques are "breathing life" into the character and adding action to words to get the

meaning across. Acting techniques deal with movement, pace, pause, silence, voice, eye contact, physical contact, contrast, positioning, and timing.

Both theatre and film actors practice these techniques. However, there still may be slight differences in some terms. For example, a theatre actor must be more exaggerated in hi movements to make them visible to every spectator, whereas a film actors' smallest movements and gestures can be seen through tight shots and camera zooming.

Some examples of actors who are honoured by their

passion in their art are the National Artists Daisy Avellana and Fernando Poe Jr.; tony Award winner Lea Salonga; and international award winners Nora Aunor and Gina Pareño.

In theatre, an actor's performance can also be attributed to the play's director and playwright. The director guides the actor in the accuracy of his or her movement and gestures on the stage. The playwright, on the other hand, takes care of the lines that serve a vital role in a play. Acting is a part that requires a three-person compact in theater.

Noted personalities in the Philippine theatre are directors Onofre Pagsanghan, Jose Estrella, Anton Juan, Maribel Legarda, Nick Lizaso, Soxie Topacio, and the late Behn Cervantes. Some prized Filipino playwright are Nicanor Tiongson who is also an art critic; Tony Perez; Paul Dumol; Bienvenido Noriega Jr.; Alberto S. Florentino; Rody Vera; and Jesus T. Peralta.

Innovation in acting techniques in theatre has been widespread, mainly because of the birth of many theatre groups in the country. Aside from professional theatres, school-based theater groups have also emerged, awakening the performing skills of young Filipinos. In the NCR region,

there are several groups in the University of the Philippines, such as *Dulaang UP*, *Anak-Tibawan*, and the *UP-Repertory Company*. Ateneo de Manila University has a theatre group for each of its level – there is the *Tanghalan Ateneo* in college. *Dulaang Sibol* in high school, and the Ateneo Children's Theatre in grade school. De La Salle University in Manila has *Harlequin Theatre*; University of Sto Tomas has *Teatro Tomasino*; Polytechnic University of the Philippines has *Sining Lahi Polyrepertory*; and the Adamson University has *Adamson Company of Talents*. Amelia Lapena-Bonifacio, dubbed as the Grand Lady of the Philippine Puppetry," founded *Teatrong Mulat ng Pilipinas*, a children's theatre and puppetry troupe.

In the regions are the *Teatro Umalohokan* of the University of the Philippines-Los Baňos, *Dulaang UP Baguio* of University of the Philippines-Baguio, *Tanghalang-SLU* of St. Louis University of Baguio, *Dagyaw Dance and Theatre Company* of Iloilo, *The University of San Carlos Theatre Guild* in Cebu, *Dulaang Atenista* of Xavier University of Cagayan de Oro. The *Integrated Performing Arts Group* of the Mindanao State University in Iligan, and *Sining Kambayoka* in Marawi City.

Activity 4.2 Subject: Traditional and alternative materials used in visual design, musical instrument, music and writing composition, choreography, cinema, and theatrical performance.

What you need:

a.6 sheets of bond paper (for each art form)

b.Cutout images or drawings of the materials used in different art forms

c.Pen, Glue, Scissors, Folder, envelope, box or, any other container

What to do:

1.Look for samples to cut out from old newspaper and a magazine or you can use actual sample. If you find materials in a book or the computer, just print, photocopy, or draw them.

2.Get at least 6 samples of traditional and alternative, materials for each form (e.g pencil for visual arts, music and literary composition and a musical instrument.)

3.Use one paper for every art form sampler.

4. Arrange the layout in either of the following.

a. Formal way --- neatly arranged in rows and columns

b. Informal way – design with your own arrangement, as in collage

5. Label each material and describe briefly how each one is used or treated in the art form (e.g., textured paper used for collage, musical instrument, etc.)

6. Note the materials that are used particularly in the art form of your region.

7. Place the samples in a folder, envelop, box or similar container. Be creative in designing your sampler's casing.

Rubrics

Criteria	20 points	15 points	10 points	5 points	0 points
Creativity	Work exceptionally, detailed, and interesting. Explores several different options and takes many creative risks	Work generally unique, detailed, and interesting Explores several different options and takes many creative risks	Work somewhat unique, detailed, and interesting Explores several different options and takes many creative risks	Work occasionally unique, detailed, and interesting Explores several different options and takes many creative risks	Work not unique, detailed, or interesting and shows no original ideas or risks taken
Use of Elements and Principles	Exceptional understanding and application of the elements of art and principles of design	Good understanding and application of the elements of art and principles of design	Basic understanding and application of the elements of art and principles of design	Minimal understanding and application of the elements of art and principles of design	No understanding and application of the elements of art and principles of design
Craftmanship	Work done with exceptional care and attention to detail and neatness	Work done with good care and attention to detail and neatness	Work done with basic care and attention to detail and neatness	Work done with minimal care and attention to detail and neatness	Work done with no care and attention to detail and neatness
Understanding, Achievement, & Completion	Exceptional understanding of project requirements. Assignment followed, and work is all complete consistent	Good understanding of project requirements. Assignment followed, and work is all complete consistent	Basic understanding of project requirements. Assignment followed, and work is all complete consistent	Minimal understanding of project requirements. Assignment followed, and work is all complete consistent	Lack of understanding of project requirements. Assignment followed, and work is all complete consistent
Effort	Work shows exceptional effort, planning, and pride.	Work shows good effort, planning, and pride	Work shows basic effort, planning, and pride	Work shows minimal effort, planning, and pride	Work shows a lack of effort, planning, and pride

Activity 4.5 On a sheet of paper, write a production plan for the following scenario.

The scenario - A grand clan reunion is coming. You and your cousins are being asked to prepare a 30-minute theatrical performance. All expenses will be paid by the committee of relatives. The only requirement is that the theme must come from a legend, a folk tale, or a classic children's story from your region. Write down your plan in detail, from the preparation to the presentation.

Here are the important guidelines.

1. Explain your plan step-by-step, from the planning and preparation to the final production.
2. Include the materials (e.g., props, costumes, etc.) and technology to be used.
3. Be creative and innovative.

Forming your values. After you have made your plan, ask yourself the following questions.

1. Was my plan clear and easy to understand?
2. Was I detailed in explaining my plan?
3. What did I fond easy in planning the production?
4. What did I find difficult during the planning?
5. Is my plan realistic and practical that is, can it be translated into real performance?

ASSESSMENT

1. An ensemble of stringed instruments played with a pick, is popular in the regions.
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